government headed by a priest who rules in the name of God or proclaims himself as a God.

Example: Vatican.

1.1.6 Democracy

A system of government in which eligible members in the population vote to elect their elected representatives, and the party or individual who obtains the majority votes forms the government.

Example: India, USA, France

1.1.7 Republic

A state in which supreme power is held by the people and their elected representatives and which has an elected or nominated President rather than a monarch.

Example: India, Australia

DO YOU KNOW?

The term 'republic' was first coined in 500 BCE in Rome. It is derived from *res publica*, a Latin word meaning public matter.

India became a Republic on 26 January 1950. It is governed in accordance with the Constitution adopted on 26 November 1949, which came into force on 26 January 1950.

1.2 What is Democracy?

- Democracy is a form of government that allows people to choose their rulers.
- Only leaders elected by people should rule the country.
- People have the freedom to express views, freedom to organise and freedom to protest.

1.2.1 Meaning of Democracy

Democracy is a system of government in which the supreme power is vested in the people of a country and people elect their representatives either directly or indirectly through fair and free elections, which are usually held periodically.

DO YOU KNOW?

The term 'democracy' is derived from two Greek words: *DEMOS* meaning people and *cratia* meaning power. Thus, literally democracy means "the power of the people".

1.2.2 Definition

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According to Mahatma Gandhi, "True democracy cannot be worked by twenty men sitting at the centre. It has to be worked from below by the people of every village."



1.2.3 Salient Features of Democracy

1. Elected representatives of people and final decision-making power to the representatives.
2. Free and fair elections.

Abraham Lincoln, one of the Presidents of USA, defines democracy as a government of the people, by the people and for the people.



Abraham Lincoln

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